



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grand County Christian Academy

School Website: <https://wpcc4him.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Grand County Christian Academy (Tabernash, CO, 80478) (public-facing materials primarily hosted by Winter Park Christian Church) presents a religiously oriented program embedded within a church community. Public materials describe spiritual formation, discipling in Jesus Christ, and faith-based activities, with explicit references to weekly Bible study, worship-oriented programming, and church-led youth/children's ministry connected to GCCA. While these elements demonstrate a strong religious foundation and communal practices, the site does not publicly articulate the liberal-arts curriculum, classical pedagogical methods, or explicit Great Books/Gaulic-style Trivium framework characteristic of a classical education. Consequently, across the six classical criteria, GCCA leans toward a predominantly Religious foundation with limited traditional classical formalism.

- Religion-based foundations: **CLASSICAL**
- School purpose and goal: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Curriculum: **NOT CLASSICAL**
- Pedagogy: **NOT CLASSICAL**
- Faculty: **NOT CLASSICAL**
- Parents & Community: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Overall, the aggregate assessment is **NOT CLASSICAL**, with notable Classical-influenced tendencies in religious formation and family/community orientation. The site does, however, provide some elements that align with classical-education speech (e.g., formation through a shared liturgical life and partnerships with families), but gaps remain in traditional classical content and pedagogy.

Note: The assessment relies on explicit textual signals from GCCA's public-facing content (primarily the Winter Park Christian Church site and GCCA-affiliated pages), and cross-checks them against the Positive/Negative keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School framework.

ABSTRACT

references to key sources:

- Public GCCA materials note a church-led educational mission, worship life, and religious formation (e.g., weekly Word-focused study, Savior-centered language, and plan-your-visit worship contexts)
- Classical-school rubric signals (positive/negative keyword indicators) are drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document set, including explicit lists of positive/negative keywords in the six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, etc.)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The GCCA materials emphasize a Savior-centered faith and Biblically grounded formation. Specific lines describe discipling and evangelizing children toward Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord, i.e., “We facilitate families in evangelizing and discipling their children toward a growing relationship with Jesus Christ as their Savior and Lord.”
- Youth/Children’s ministry language explicitly references studying God’s Word and worship life in a church context (e.g., “studying God’s Word,” and church worship settings).
- Public materials situate GCCA within a church community (Winter Park Christian Church) and include plan-your-visit worship, Sunday services, and family ministries, signaling liturgical and communal religious practice.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators present: theology/theology-informed formation; liturgical/worship life; Word of God references; Savior—central to mission; communal worship context (e.g., weekly Word study, Sunday services). Core terms align with Positive Keyword Indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices as defined in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. See the Six Essential Elements positive keyword lists (e.g., Truth, Word of God, Theology, Liturgical practices).
- Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no explicit secularization, no value-neutral ethics, etc., in the visible GCCA pages). The absence of explicit secular/neutral framing reinforces the religious orientation rather than an opposing signal.

Why this rating

- The school’s public materials deliver clear religious foundations (GCCA as part of a church ecosystem; explicit language about Jesus, Savior, and Word of God; worship and communal religious life). This aligns with the Positive Keyword cluster for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and outweighs potential neutral or secular tendencies in the same domain. Thus, CLASSICAL is warranted for this category, with strong religious-metaphysical signals.

Cited evidence:

- “We facilitate families in evangelizing and discipling their children toward a growing relationship with Jesus Christ as their Savior and Lord.”
- “We meet weekly during the school year with high school students for fun, fellowship and studying God’s Word.” (Youth Ministry)
- Plan/plan-your-visit worship contexts and weekly ministry settings tied to GCCA within a church structure.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The visible public materials emphasize spiritual formation and discipleship as primary aims (e.g., evangelizing and discipling children toward Christ). This signals formation-oriented aims rather than vocational preparation per se. The explicit phrase “growing relationship with Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord” anchors formation-oriented spiritual goals.
- There is emphasis on ministry and community formation (youth and family programs) rather than explicitly “Great Books,” “virtue formation” through liberal arts canon, or classical telos. The church-centered language leans toward formation of faith-life and community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation of affections/character (formation; discipling); teleology oriented toward truth in a spiritual sense; concept of human flourishing tied to spiritual ends (as found in the positive keyword cluster for Formation and Truth/Goodness/Beauty within the classical rubric, though in a religious frame). See the Six Essential Elements literature on formation and teleology.
- Negative indicators: lack of explicit classical liberal arts content (no Great Books, no Trivium/Quadrivium references, no explicit pursuit of the liberal-arts canon), which are central to a Classically oriented education in the standard rubric. This absence constitutes a significant lacuna relative to a full classical program.

Why this rating

- The program prioritizes formation and spiritual-to-moral development (formation over information) but with a Catholic/Protestant faith framework and church-based programming rather than a liberal-arts canon or classical pedagogy. The alignment to classical aims is partial and faith-centered, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence:

- “We facilitate families in evangelizing and discipling their children toward a growing relationship with Jesus Christ as their Savior and Lord.”
- References to youth/children’s ministry and Word-based study, indicating formation as central, but not a robust liberal-arts canon.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe religious programming (Bible study, Sunday School, Vacation Bible School, church events) rather than a traditional liberal-arts curriculum. The explicit curricular framework of Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or formal Trivium/Quadrivium is not present in GCCA’s public pages. Instead, the material centers on Sunday School, biblical education, worship, and church-centered activities.
- There is no mention of Great Books, primary sources, or classical texts in the GCCA public content; no explicit integration of history as a discipline through the liberal-arts lens; rather, biblical education and church activities predominate.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators: category-specific classical curriculum signals (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books) are not present; thus no positive indicators for classical curriculum appear in GCCA’s public-facing content.
- Negative indicators: the lack of the classical curriculum hallmarks (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; canonical Western heritage texts) is explicit in absence, consistent with a NOT CLASSICAL curriculum approach per the rubric.

Why this rating

- Absence of the classical liberal-arts curriculum signals (no Great Books, no Trivium/Quadrivium, no canonical Western-text orientation) yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Cited evidence:

- Sunday School/Nursery/Vacation Bible School and other church-based programming listed as curriculum activities rather than liberal-arts canon.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public-facing materials emphasize religious formation, ministry contexts, and plan-your-visit worship rather than explicit, classical pedagogy such as Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, or memorization/recitation practices. No explicit Socratic method, Harkness-style discussion, or structured memory work is described in GCCA's public pages. The content centers on ministry, family formation, and Bible education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators for classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation) are not present in the public GCCA materials.
- The absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals (and presence of faith-based ministry and Bible study) points toward NOT CLASSICAL Pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The absence of the hallmark classical pedagogical methods (Socratic seminar, restfulness in learning as a regular pedagogy, memorization/recitation practices, or formal imitation-based training) yields NOT CLASSICAL in Pedagogy.

Cited evidence:

- GCCA pages describe Bible study and church-based activities rather than classical pedagogical frameworks.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public-facing materials show a Head of School and a staff directory, but there is no explicit evidence describing faculty as living curriculum, mentors, or the “portrait” of teacher-student ideal in the classical sense. The material reflects standard staff roles (Head of School; Worship Leader; Administrative staff) rather than a classical faculty model emphasizing virtue exemplars or “living curriculum.”

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords for Faculty (as defined in the classical lexicon) include: model teachers and mentors; portrait of what a teacher should be; living curriculum; collegial and virtuous faculty. None of these explicit faculty traits appear in GCCA's public pages.
- Negative keywords are not explicitly evidenced either; however, the absence of classical faculty descriptors supports NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- Even though there is a formal staff structure (Head of School, leaders), GCCA's public-facing materials do not present the classical “faculty as living curriculum” or explicit model-mentor culture. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Cited evidence:

- Head of School and staff references in GCCA materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- GCCA operates within Winter Park Christian Church, signaling a community-forward, faith-based ecosystem with family-facing programming (Children's Ministry, Youth Ministry) and events for families. The presence of joint church-school programming (e.g., Bible study events, family ministries) signals some level of partnership with families and community formation. The public content includes “plan-your-visit” and family-oriented ministry language that suggests partnership with families and involvement in a faith-based community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators present: partnership with families and community rhythm (family involvement in church ministries; plan-your-visit; community events). The classical lexicon signals partnerships with families as co-educators and a culture of household formation. The GCCA site demonstrates family/Church integration rather than a purely school-centric model.
- Negative indicators: there is no explicit, detailed description of parent-as-co-teachers, formal parent-education programs (e.g., book studies, parent formation groups) that some classical schools emphasize in their “Partnership with Families” section. The signals are present but not exhaustive or explicit in the classical sense.

Why this rating

- The presence of a church-based community with family/ministry involvement yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL because it aligns with the category’s emphasis on partnership with families and community formation, but lacking explicit classical-parent-education programs. The site’s emphasis is faith-based community rather than classical parent-education infrastructure.

Cited evidence:

- GCCA materials showing family/ministry integration within a church context.
- Church-side plan-your-visit and family-oriented ministry content.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aimed to reach CLASSICAL status across all six categories, explicit additions would help:
- Curriculum: articulate and publicize a classical-canon curriculum (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, primary historical sources) alongside or integrated with biblical study, clarifying how Western civilization and classical texts anchor the curriculum.
- Pedagogy: introduce and publicize classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue in upper grades, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation and practice) in line with classical ideals.
- Faculty: develop a “living curriculum” or teacher-formation profile that presents teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors, with visible paths for teacher development aligned with classical pedagogy.
- Parents & Community: formalize and communicate a partnership framework with families as co-educators (parent training, classical book clubs, parent formation events) and maintain an open-campus posture that invites parental engagement.
- Element 1 (Religious Foundations) and Element 2 (Purpose/Goal) can be strengthened by explicitly tying formation to virtues and the truth-good-beauty triad within a classical framework, while maintaining the faith-based orientation.

Note: Since the aggregate ranking for GCCA is NOT CLASSICAL, the needle-mover section emphasizes not mandatory changes but suggested steps if pursuing a deeper classical alignment in the future.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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